

D353

Strategic Training and Development

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

Method © 2026 Erik Daniel Lindquist — Course Mastery Coach, armored drill. Items drafted with AI assistance under his direction.

How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

Before designing a sales training program, an HR team compares each rep's quarterly numbers and skills-test results to decide which reps need training. The company is based in Atlanta and sells industrial pumps. Which level of needs analysis is this?

- A. Organizational analysis.
- B. Market analysis, because the company sells industrial pumps.
- C. Task analysis.
- D. Person analysis.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which question belongs in a task analysis?

- A. Does training fit the company's strategy and budget?
- B. What knowledge, skills, and steps does a claims processor's job require?
- C. How satisfied were trainees with the course?
- D. Which employees lack the required skills?

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

Call-center agents score 95 percent on a product-knowledge test but still skip a required verification step, because the system takes 90 seconds to load it and their pay is based on calls per hour. The center has 250 agents and moved to a new building last year. What is the best recommendation?

- A. Retrain agents on the verification step.
- B. Move the team back to its old building.
- C. More training always closes performance gaps.
- D. Fix the system delay and adjust incentives so the step is not penalized.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

An instructional designer has finished interviewing managers and has written learning objectives and a course outline with an assessment plan. The project sponsor is in finance, and the budget is \$40,000. Which ADDIE phase comes next?

- A. Evaluation.
- B. Analysis.
- C. Development.
- D. Implementation.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A team is building slides, videos, and job aids and pilot-testing the materials. Which ADDIE phase did the team just finish?

- A. Analysis.
- B. Implementation.
- C. Development.
- D. Design.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A group of experienced nurses resists a new charting course that opens with lectures on basics they already know. The course runs in a room with new tablets, and the hospital recently won a quality award. Which change best applies adult learning principles?

- A. Start with real charting problems they face, draw on their experience, and let them skip content they have mastered.
- B. Teach them as you would teach children, with step-by-step drills from the basics.
- C. Add more lectures to make sure nothing is missed.
- D. Use the new tablets for every activity.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

Which is the best-written learning objective for a forklift safety course, which runs on Saturdays at the Fresno warehouse?

- A. Given a loaded forklift, the trainee will complete the 12-point pre-shift inspection with no missed items.
- B. Trainees will always be perfectly safe.
- C. The instructor will present forklift safety rules.
- D. Trainees will understand forklift safety.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

An objective reads: Trainees will appreciate the importance of data privacy. What is its main flaw?

- A. It lacks a budget line.
- B. “Appreciate” is not observable or measurable.
- C. Objectives should never address attitudes.
- D. It is too specific.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A safety training program cost \$50,000. Over the next year, injury-related costs fell by \$80,000. Trainees rated it 4.6 out of 5, and the program ran in six sessions. What is the ROI?

- A. 37.5%
- B. 60%
- C. 160%
- D. \$30,000

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A training program cost \$80,000 and produced an ROI of 25 percent. What were its total benefits?

- A. \$320,000
- B. \$20,000
- C. \$100,000
- D. \$105,000

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

After a leadership course that participants rated highly, new supervisors fall back into old habits within weeks. Their own managers never discuss the course, and there are no chances to practice. The course was held in a downtown hotel with catered lunches. What is the most effective fix?

- A.** Build manager support and on-the-job practice with follow-up.
- B.** Nothing; high ratings prove the course worked.
- C.** Hold the course in the office instead of a hotel.
- D.** Make the course longer.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A manager wants to prepare a high-potential analyst for a future leadership role. The analyst has already finished two online leadership courses and holds an MBA. Under the 70-20-10 model, what should make up the largest share of her development?

- A.** Mentoring and coaching.
- B.** More formal courses.
- C.** Challenging on-the-job assignments such as stretch projects or job rotation.
- D.** A second graduate degree, building on her MBA.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer D Concept 1

Before designing a sales training program, an HR team compares each rep's quarterly numbers and skills-test results to decide which reps need training. ~~The company is based in Atlanta and sells industrial pumps.~~ Which level of needs analysis is this?

Target word: needs-analysis level **Decides:** Identifying which individuals need training.

A	Confusion set	That checks strategy, support, and resources.
B	Camouflage	The product line does not decide the level.
C	Adjacent category	That defines what the job requires, not who lacks it.
D	Correct	It identifies who needs training.

2. Answer B Concept 1 • transfer

Which question belongs in a task analysis?

Target word: task-analysis question — reverse **Decides:** Focus on the job's requirements.

A	Confusion set	That is organizational analysis.
B	Correct	Task analysis defines job requirements.
C	Adjacent category	That is evaluation, not needs analysis.
D	Inverted operation	That is person analysis.

3. Answer D Concept 2

Call-center agents score 95 percent on a product-knowledge test but still skip a required verification step, because the system takes 90 seconds to load it and their pay is based on calls per hour. ~~The center has 250 agents and moved to a new building last year.~~ What is the best recommendation?

Target word: best fix **Decides:** Agents know how; the system and pay work against it.

A	Adjacent category	They already know it; training will not change the incentive.
B	Camouflage	The location does not decide the behavior.
C	Absolute language	Training fixes only skill gaps.
D	Correct	The gap is environmental, not a skill gap.

4. Answer C Concept 3

An instructional designer has finished interviewing managers and has written learning objectives and a course outline with an assessment plan. ~~The project sponsor is in finance, and the budget is \$40,000.~~ Which ADDIE phase comes next?

Target word: next phase **Decides:** Objectives and outline = design is done.

A	Adjacent category	Evaluation follows delivery.
B	Inverted operation	Goes backward; analysis is already done.
C	Correct	Materials are built after design.
D	Dropped element	Skips building the materials.

5. Answer D Concept 3 • transfer

A team is building slides, videos, and job aids and pilot-testing the materials. Which ADDIE phase did the team just finish?

Target word: previous phase — reverse **Decides:** Building materials = development, so design came before.

A	Dropped element	Skips the design phase.
B	Inverted operation	Implementation comes after development.
C	Confusion set	That is the phase they are in now.
D	Correct	Development follows design.

6. Answer A Concept 4

A group of experienced nurses resists a new charting course that opens with lectures on basics they already know. ~~The course runs in a room with new tablets, and the hospital recently won a quality award.~~ Which change best applies adult learning principles?

Target word: adult-learning fix **Decides:** Experienced learners need relevance and to use their experience.

A	Correct	Problem-centered, relevant, and self-directed.
B	Adjacent category	That is pedagogy, not andragogy.
C	Inverted operation	More of what they resist.
D	Camouflage	Tools do not fix relevance.

7. Answer A Concept 5

Which is the best-written learning objective for a forklift safety course, ~~which runs on Saturdays at the Fresno warehouse?~~

Target word: best objective **Decides:** Observable behavior, condition, and standard.

A	Correct	States the condition, behavior, and standard.
B	Absolute language	Not measurable or realistic.
C	Inverted operation	Describes the trainer, not the learner.
D	Dropped element	“Understand” cannot be observed or measured.

8. Answer B Concept 5 • transfer

An objective reads: Trainees will appreciate the importance of data privacy. What is its main flaw?

Target word: diagnose the flaw — reverse **Decides:** “Appreciate” is not observable.

A	Adjacent category	Budgets are not part of objectives.
B	Correct	Objectives need action verbs.
C	Absolute language	Attitude objectives are fine when written with observable behaviors.
D	Inverted operation	The problem is vagueness.

9. Answer B Concept 6

A safety training program cost \$50,000. Over the next year, injury-related costs fell by \$80,000. ~~Trainees rated it 4.6 out of 5, and the program ran in six sessions.~~ What is the ROI?

Target word: ROI percent **Decides:** $(\$80,000 - \$50,000) \div \$50,000$.

A	Inverted operation	Divides net benefit by benefits instead of costs.
B	Correct	$\$30,000 \div \$50,000 = 60\%$.
C	Adjacent category	Benefit $\div$ cost is a benefit-cost ratio, not ROI.
D	Dropped element	Net benefit without dividing by cost.

10. Answer C Concept 6 • transfer

A training program cost \$80,000 and produced an ROI of 25 percent. What were its total benefits?

Target word: solve for benefits **Decides:** Benefits = cost $\times$ (1 + ROI).

A	Inverted operation	$\$80,000 \div 0.25$ divides instead of multiplying.
B	Dropped element	That is the net gain only.
C	Correct	$\$80,000 \times 1.25 = \$100,000$.
D	Adjacent category	Adds 25,000 as a flat amount instead of 25 percent.

11. Answer A Concept 7

After a leadership course that participants rated highly, new supervisors fall back into old habits within weeks. Their own managers never discuss the course, and there are no chances to practice. ~~The course was held in a downtown hotel with catered lunches.~~ What is the most effective fix?

Target word: transfer fix **Decides:** No manager support and no practice.

A	Correct	Support and practice drive transfer.
B	Confusion set	Reaction (Level 1) is not behavior change (Level 3).
C	Camouflage	Venue does not decide transfer.
D	Adjacent category	More class time does not create on-the-job support.

12. Answer C Concept 8

A manager wants to prepare a high-potential analyst for a future leadership role. ~~The analyst has already finished two online leadership courses and holds an MBA.~~ Under the 70-20-10 model, what should make up the largest share of her development?

Target word: largest share **Decides:** About 70 percent comes from on-the-job experience.

A	Adjacent category	Valuable, but that is the 20 percent.
B	Inverted operation	Courses are the smallest share.
C	Correct	Experience is the 70 percent.
D	Camouflage	Her credentials do not decide the model's mix.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owled.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	5	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	10	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	9	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	3	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	4	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	5	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Three levels of needs analysis	Organizational analysis checks strategy and resources; task analysis defines what the job requires; person analysis identifies who needs training.	Mixing up task (the job) and person (the employee).	Strategy (organization), job duties (task), or individual gaps (person).
2	Training fixes skill gaps only	Training solves “can’t do” problems; when people know how but don’t (systems, incentives, resources), fix the environment instead.	Prescribing more training for every performance gap.	High test scores but poor on-the-job results.
3	ADDIE sequence	Analysis → Design → Development → Implementation → Evaluation.	Jumping from design to delivery, or mixing up design and development.	Objectives and outlines (design) vs. building materials (development).
4	Adult learning (andragogy)	Adults learn best when training is relevant, problem-centered, self-directed, and builds on their experience.	Treating adults like children with more lecture.	Experienced learners resisting basic lectures.
5	Measurable learning objectives	A good objective states an observable behavior, the conditions, and a standard, using action verbs.	Using verbs like “understand” or “appreciate,” or writing from the trainer’s view.	“Which is the best-written objective?”
6	Training ROI	$ROI = (\text{benefits} - \text{costs}) \div \text{costs} \times 100$.	Dividing by benefits or reporting benefits ÷ costs as ROI.	Program cost and dollar benefits.
7	Transfer of training	Skills transfer to the job when managers support them and learners get chances to practice and follow-up.	Assuming high satisfaction means skills will stick.	Good ratings but people revert to old habits.
8	70-20-10 development	Most development (about 70 percent) comes from challenging on-the-job experience, about 20 percent from others (mentoring, coaching), and about 10 percent from formal courses.	Adding more classes for high-potential employees.	Developing someone for a future role.

Course scope (public description): Training and development is most effective when it aligns with strategy. This course shows you how to design programs that grow talent, build capability, and strengthen organizational performance. You will apply learning theories and design principles to create development experiences that help employees succeed and prepare organizations for the future.